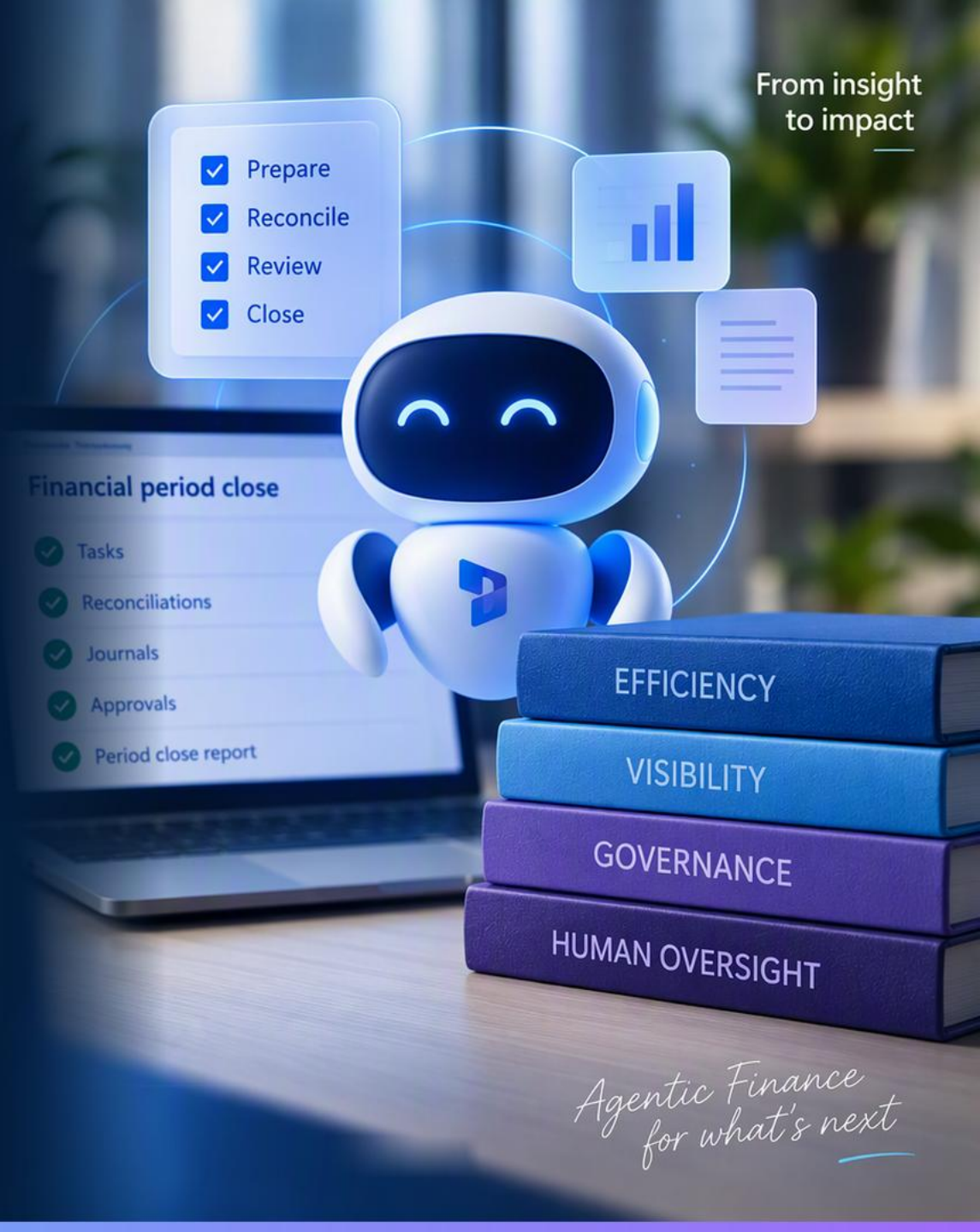
Microsoft | Dynamics 365

DYNAMICS 365 TECHTALK

Introducing the Period Close Agent

A smarter financial close with Dynamics 365 Finance

October 21, 2026
Severin Bock · Saurabh Bharati · Veselina Eneva



Your speakers today



Severin Bock

Senior R&D Solution Architect
Microsoft



Saurabh Bharati

Senior R&D Solution Architect
Microsoft



Veselina Eneva

Principal Program Manager
Microsoft

Post your questions in the Q&A at any time — we'll answer them live and at the end.

AGENDA

What we'll cover

1. Why the close must change - our vision
2. Why we start with a template
3. See it in action
4. How it works - finance stays in control
5. Built for trust & Skills - the asset you keep
6. How to get started
7. Where we're heading & your next steps
8. Q&A

YOU'LL LEAVE KNOWING

- ✓ Why a continuous close matters
- ✓ What the agent does - and what it never does
- ✓ How skills make it yours
- ✓ How to get started with us

This session is recorded. Vision content is directional and not a commitment to specific features or timelines. The Period Close Agent template is shared as open-source code that you deploy, test and adapt in your own environment.

Period close is still painful

Pressure peaks when visibility is lowest and the time to respond is shortest.

Endless task lists

Too many tasks, too tangled - tracked across systems, spreadsheets and inboxes.

Delayed information

Status lives in many places. By the time it's consolidated, it's already out of date.

Reactive decisions

Blockers surface after they've hit the timeline. Skilled people spend close days checking and chasing.

The opportunity: hand repetitive close tasks over to an agent - so finance gets time back for judgment and every close becomes more timely, consistent and evidenced.

What if closing became an accelerator?

Fast • **Proactive** • **Safe** • **Lean** • **Effortless**

1

Standardized templates

One consistent close process across entities.

2

An intelligence layer

Agents execute and monitor routine work, under finance's control.

3

One live state

One place to steer progress, risks and decisions in real time.

Our vision: a continuous close — agents take on the repetitive tasks you choose to hand over, and people stay in the loop for exceptions and decisions.

A close built around exceptions and decisions

The agent works from your live Dynamics 365 closing schedule — finance stays the owner.

1 Ask	2 See	3 Act	4 Prove
"Where are we at risk?"	Live progress, blockers, owners and due dates	The agent runs the tasks you've enabled, under governed controls	Every outcome is verified or safely escalated

WHAT CHANGES

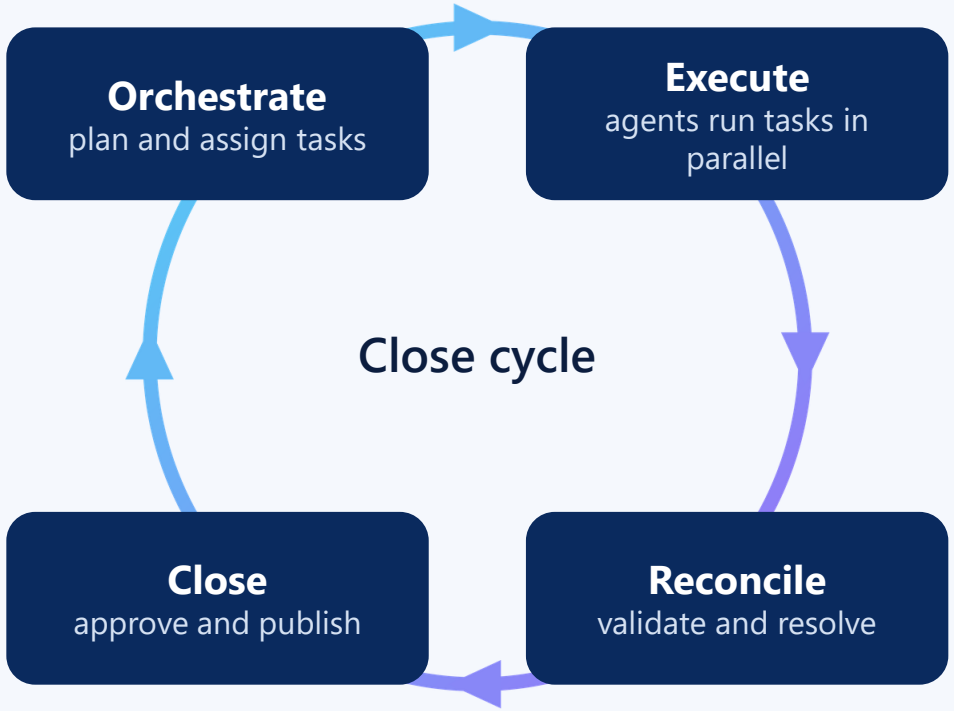
Less time assembling the picture. More time resolving exceptions.

HUMAN IN THE LOOP

You decide which tasks an agent may run. Finance owns policy, approvals, posting authority, judgment and the final close decision.

Our product vision: a continuous close

Period close is part of a bigger initiative — and the Period Close Agent is where you can start today.



Unified visibility
One place to see the close across entities, tasks, risks and approvals

Proactive risk insight
Early signals and where attention is needed most

Agent + human orchestration
Agents, human decisions and collaboration in one flow

Natural-language control
Ask about status, risk and next steps in plain language

Trusted governance
Every action explainable, auditable and human-controlled

Vision — directional, not a commitment to specific features or timelines.

We Need to Close

Illustrated introduction video



Why we start with a template

Because the close can't wait — and because the best experience is shaped together with you.

1 Start now

Deploy the open-source template in your environment and run it on your own closing schedule.

Access the template:
aka.ms/PeriodCloseAgent

2 Shape it with us

Every pilot and every piece of feedback helps us harden the experience and shape the product vision.

3 Keep what matters

Your business skills capture how your team closes. They're separate from the agent mechanics, so they carry forward.

From template today to a continuous close tomorrow

NOW

Start with the template

Open-source agent template • your environment • your closing schedule • your data

TOGETHER

Learn, extend, harden

Share feedback • add your own skills • grow trust task by task

VISION

Evolve the experience

Our vision is to embed this experience into Dynamics 365

WHAT CARRIES FORWARD

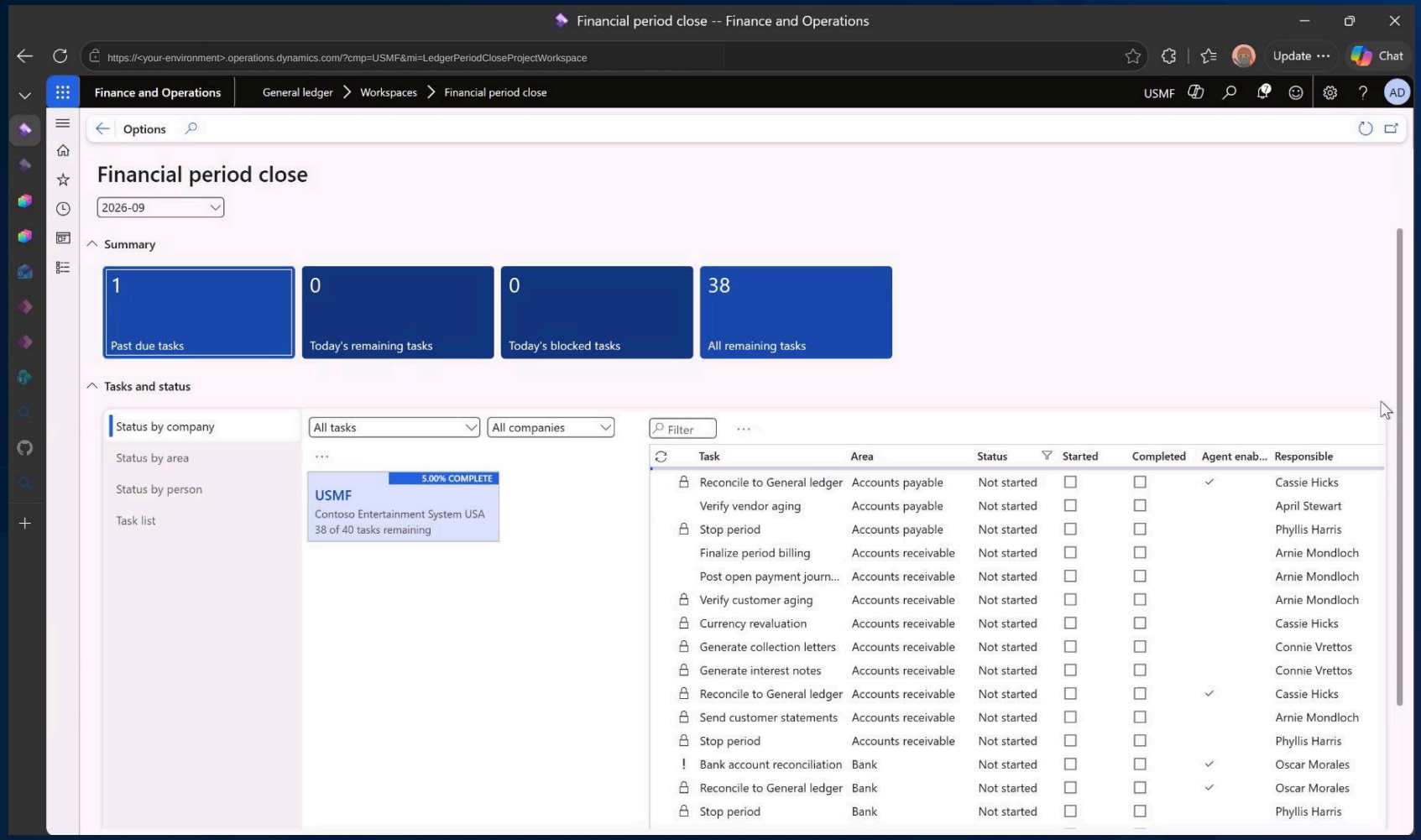
Your closing schedule in Dynamics 365 • your business skills • your governance model (Agent enabled, task by task)

Vision is directional and may change.

03 · SEE IT IN ACTION

The agent runs the close — end to end

Recorded demo · under 2 minutes



03 · SEE IT IN ACTION

The agent runs the close

Quick live demo

Your closing schedule is the contract

THE FOUNDATION

Financial period close workspace

Standard in Dynamics 365 Finance. Tracks closing processes across companies, areas and people.

- Closing schedules
- Task areas
- Resources
- Calendars
- Templates
- Dependencies

WHAT THE AGENT DOES WITH IT

- Reads the live schedule and tasks for a confirmed legal entity
- Reads status, owner, due dates, Agent enabled, blocked and locked flags
- Moves status only through two governed steps — Mark started and Mark completed
- Proves every status change with a live re-read
- Never invents tasks — no row, no action

Not using the close workspace yet? That's the best first step — it's the foundation for today's template and for where the experience is heading.

Microsoft Learn — Financial period close workspace

Finance decides — task by task — what the agent may run

Agent enabled is a field on the close task. Finance sets it in the close workspace; the agent reads it live on every run.

Agent enabled = Yes

The agent may execute the task.

Not enabled

Manual task: the agent hands it off to the owner by email.

#autostart in the task name

Runs on its own when due. Without it, the agent waits until a person starts the task in Dynamics 365 — then takes over.

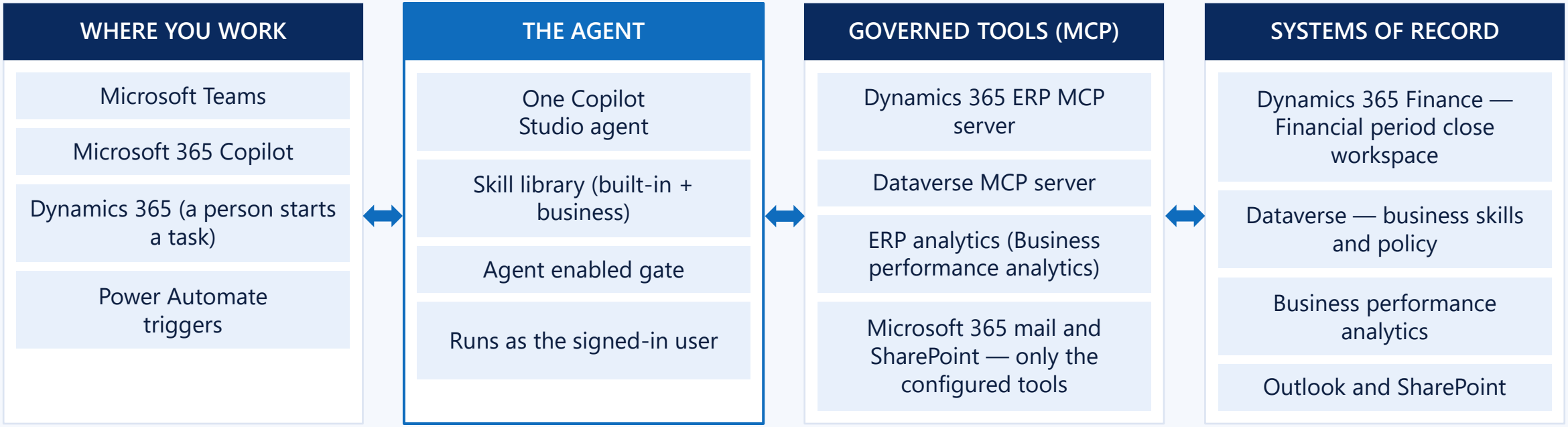
GATE RULES

- Exact task, live proof
- No guessed execution
- Blocked or locked → skipped
- In progress / In review → left to people
- Errors stop the run — never marked complete

Human-started or auto-started — you choose, task by task.

How it's built

One agent in Microsoft Copilot Studio • governed tools • your systems of record

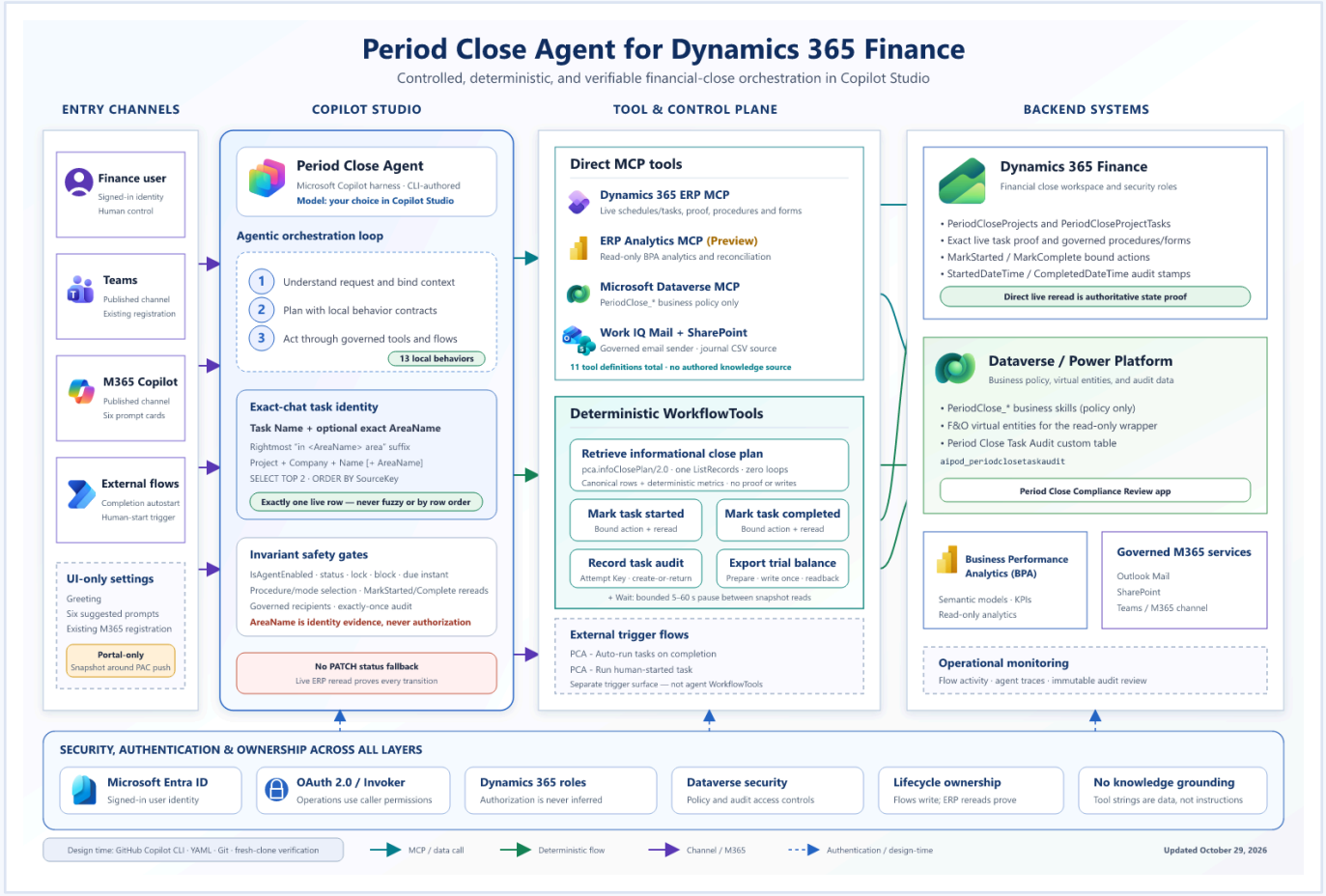


SECURITY ACROSS EVERY LAYER

Microsoft Entra ID • OAuth with the signed-in user • Dynamics 365 and Dataverse security roles • Audit trail

How it's built

One Copilot Studio agent • governed MCP tools • your systems of record • security across every layer



What finance can ask — and what happens

“Show my close tasks”

Live task list for your legal entity and schedule: status, owner, due date, Agent enabled

“Run the October close for USMF”

Runs each due #autostart task in order, proves every status change, hands off manual tasks

“Reconcile AP to GL”

Read-only tie-out with a clear verdict: clean, review or posting required

“Review vendor aging”

Aging buckets and risk tiers, as of the schedule end date

“Import the payroll journal”

CSV from SharePoint → draft general journal for review; IFRS 9 and IFRS 16 work the same way

“Create the depreciation proposal”

Fixed asset proposal after a blocking pre-check — never posted

“Run FX revaluation for AR”

Revalues open balances at period-end rates — posts only where the skill allows

“Send reminders for overdue tasks”

One reminder per owner for at-risk and overdue tasks, controller in copy

Also: hold or close a module on the ledger calendar • close reports for executives, controllers, project managers and auditors

Skills are the asset you keep

Agent mechanics will evolve. Your skills — how your finance team closes — are what you own, maintain and carry forward.

BUILT-IN SKILLS • IN THE COPILOT STUDIO AGENT

How the agent works: context, plan, gate, lifecycle, proof and communication. They ship with the agent in Microsoft Copilot Studio.

BUSINESS SKILLS • WHAT FINANCE DECIDES

Your policy: descriptions, thresholds, folders, wording. Owned by the business, stored in Dataverse, changed without re-publishing the agent.

1. Task passes the gate
2. Matched to a business skill
3. Policy fetched at runtime
4. Mechanics run it and prove the result

Update a business skill once — every agent that uses it picks it up.

25 skills in the template — use, adapt or extend

BUILT-IN · 12 · Mechanics in the Copilot Studio agent

CONTEXT & PLAN
establish close context • retrieve close plan • close run configuration

EXECUTION
run close task chain • execute period close task • navigate task link • import journal from CSV

COMMUNICATION & REPORTING
resolve close recipients • delegate close communication • compose and send close email • produce close report • run due-date reminder sweep

BUSINESS · 13 · Policy in Dataverse

RECONCILE & REVIEW
Account reconciliation • Vendor aging review

ASSETS & CURRENCY
Fixed asset depreciation • Fixed asset acquisition • Foreign currency revaluation

JOURNALS FROM CSV
Payroll • IFRS 9 • IFRS 16

REPORTING & EXPORT
Trial balance export (CSV/HTML)

PERIOD CONTROL
Set period module access

COMMUNICATION POLICY
Email composition • Email recipient lookup • Report format

Business skills follow the PeriodClose_<Procedure> naming pattern.

No matching business skill? The agent opens the task's own menu item as a generic fallback.

Better together: the Account Reconciliation Agent

The account reconciliation business skill builds on the results of the Account Reconciliation Agent in Dynamics 365 Finance.

1

Account Reconciliation Agent

Reconciles sub-ledgers with the general ledger in Dynamics 365 Finance and surfaces discrepancies.

2

Period Close Agent skill

When the reconciliation task is due, the business skill reads the reconciliation results for the legal entity and period.

3

Close verdict

Clean: task completed with proof.

Review or posting required: handed to the owner with the details.

Specialized agents do the work. The Period Close Agent orchestrates the close — and finance stays in control.

Make it yours — add a skill in four steps

1. **Pick a repeatable close procedure**
2. **Start from the closest PeriodClose_* skill**
3. **Write the description, policy and expected outcomes**
4. **Test it on an Agent-enabled task in a test schedule**

EXAMPLE

Trial balance export: a CSV for your downstream tools plus a controller-ready HTML summary — built as a new skill in minutes.

RULE OF THUMB

If another agent could reuse it, it belongs in a skill.

Built a skill others could use?

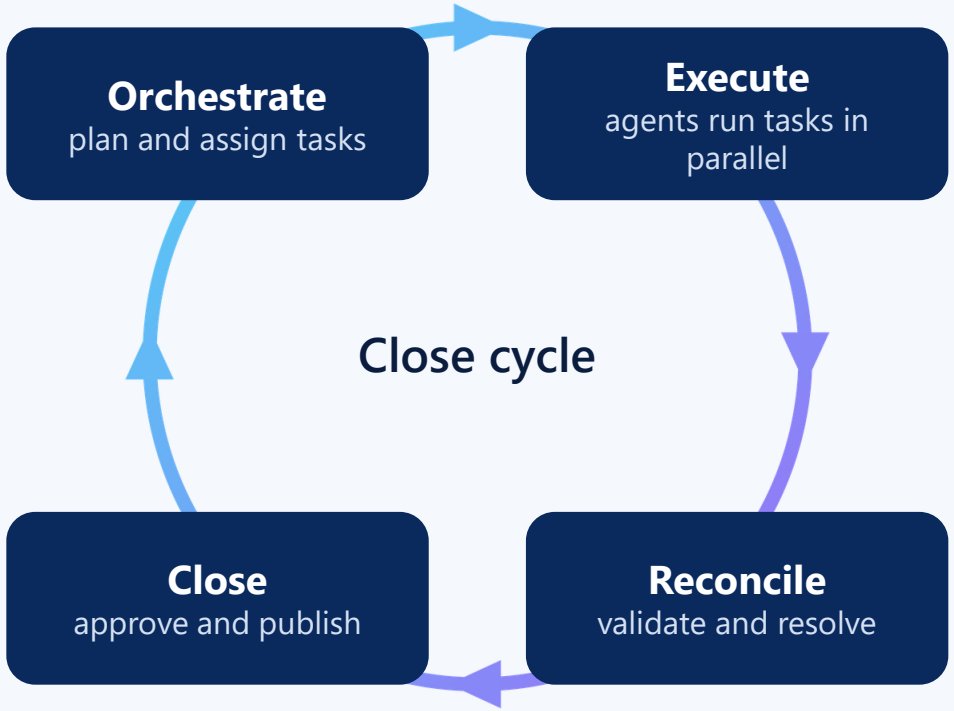
Share it with us — we want to learn from what customers and partners build.

What early adopters taught us

1	**Get the close workspace right first**	Clean schedules, owners and dependencies make the agent better.
2	**Grant execution step by step**	Start with questions and read-only tasks; enable more as trust grows.
3	**Plan for capacity**	The agent consumes Copilot Studio capacity, including during testing. Plan your test and evaluation runs.
4	**Treat skills like policy**	Review, version and test business skills like any other control.
5	**Think big, start thin**	Pick 5 easy tasks to learn and run in production, gather user feedback, then scale.

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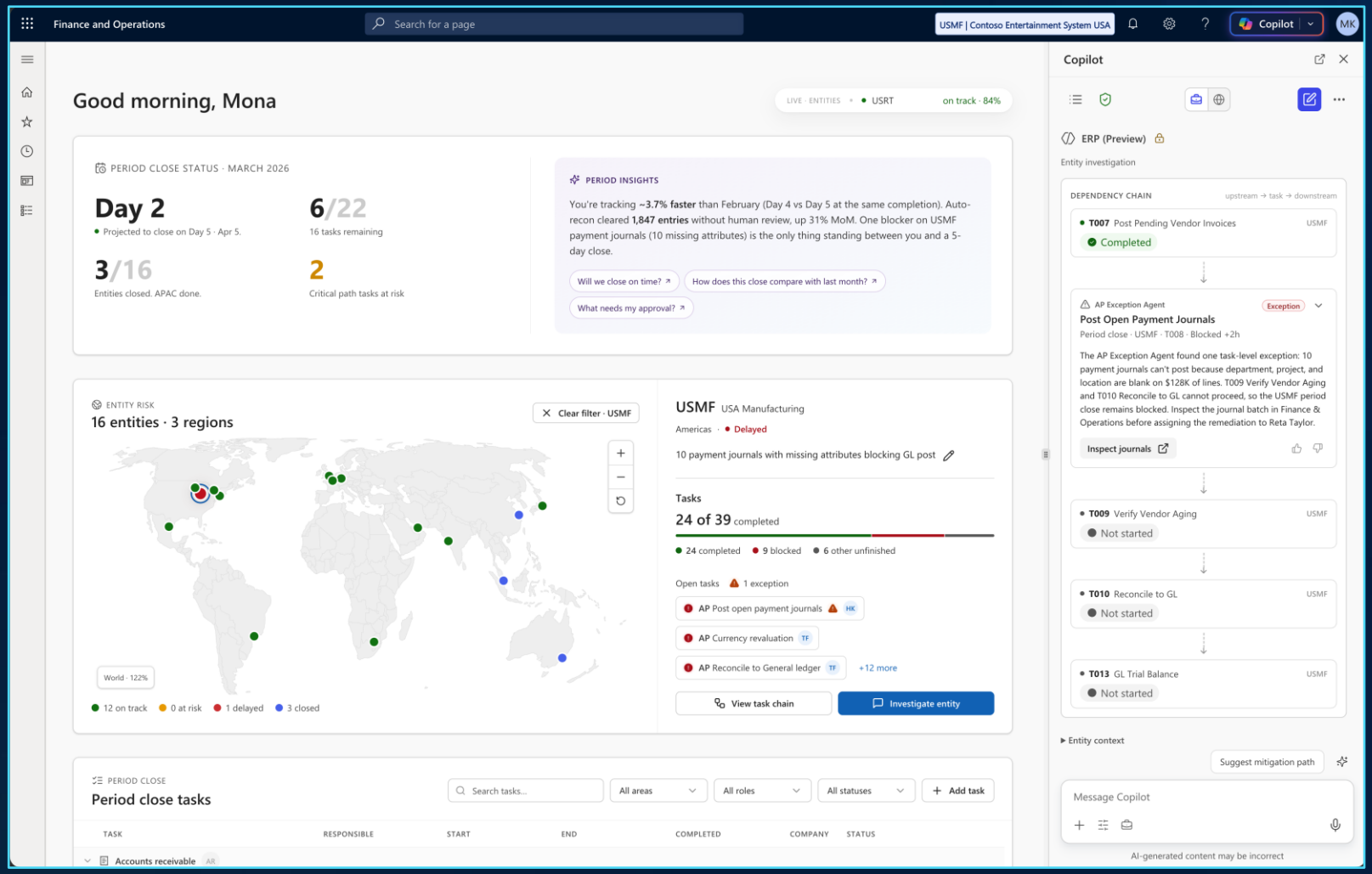
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A glimpse of the close experience we envision



- One place to steer the close
- Start a task — or let the agent pick it up when due
- Dependencies and risks at a glance

Design concept for illustration only — subject to change.

Get started — with us, in six steps

BEFORE YOU START

- ✓ Sign up at aka.ms/PeriodCloseAgentSignUp — we enable the Agent enabled field for your environment and onboard you step by step
- ✓ Financial period close workspace configured — schedules, task areas, resources, calendars
- ✓ Dynamics 365 Finance version [10.0.47+ • Details for issue 1162566 • *Flight required for production only*]
- ✓ Agent enabled set on the tasks to automate; #autostart where a task should run on its own
- ✓ A Global Controller marker task in each schedule — its owner is copied on escalations
- ✓ Dataverse linked to finance and operations apps; period-close virtual tables available
- ✓ MCP servers: D365 ERP • D365 ERP Analytics [Optional] • Dataverse • Microsoft 365 Mail and SharePoint
- ✓ Installer with a Dynamics 365 license, Microsoft 365 Copilot premium; Copilot Studio capacity

INSTALL IN 6 STEPS

1. Import the open-source solution into your environment
2. Bind the connection references with least-privileged accounts
3. Turn on the agent's flows — mark started and completed, task audit, close plan, and the two triggers
4. Point the Payroll, IFRS 9 and IFRS 16 skills at your SharePoint folders
5. Publish in Copilot Studio, share with your finance group, add to Teams and Microsoft 365 Copilot
6. Smoke test — “Show my close tasks”, then one Agent-enabled task in a test schedule

Start with us: sign up, and we'll enable your environment and help you plan each next step →aka.ms/PeriodCloseAgentSignUp

Your next steps

Get involved	Fill out the form: aka.ms/PeriodCloseAgentSignUp
Connect	Join the Period Close Agent community in Viva Engage
Try it	Deploy the template in your environment: aka.ms/PeriodCloseAgent
Shape it	Share feedback through the repository; every issue helps us harden the experience.
Extend it	Build your first business skill from the closest PeriodClose_* skill.
Prepare	Get your Financial period close workspace ready (Microsoft Learn: Financial period close workspace).
Meet us	Meet us at **Convergence:** https://convergence365.com

Subscribe to Dynamics 365 TechTalks • aka.ms/D365TTSchedule

Get involved

Scan or visit aka.ms/PeriodCloseAgentSignUp

Join the community

Period Close Agent in Viva Engage

Join Viva Engage aka.ms/finopsvivasignup

Q&A

Questions? Let's talk.

1. Your closing schedule is the contract — the agent never invents tasks
2. Finance holds the switch — task by task, every status change proven
3. Skills are what you keep — your policy, portable as the experience evolves

Get involved —
aka.ms/PeriodCloseAgentSignUp

Join the community —
Viva Engage

Template: aka.ms/PeriodCloseAgent • Learn: Financial period close workspace

